Ethics, governance and risk note

Extracted from Section 7 of the final report.

Risk register

#	Risk	Severity
R1	Hallucinated or unsupported statements in a summary lead a reviewer to act on something never reported	High
R2	Automation complacency — reviewers stop reading the original reports and oversight becomes ceremonial	High
R3	A serious issue is ranked low, signed off routinely, and surfaces days later as an escalation	High
R4	Campus or role scoping failure exposes one campus's operational data to another	Critical
R5	Personal data of students or staff is sent to a third-party model API without a clear basis	High
R6	Systematic bias against particular campuses, associates or writing styles	High
R7	Function creep — the layer is quietly repurposed for staff performance evaluation	High
R8	Over-claiming in internal communication creates expectations the system cannot meet	Medium
R9	Key-person dependency on a single builder and owner	High

Harm scenarios

- A Business Operations Associate honestly reports a genuine problem in plain, non-fluent English. The model rates it low because it lacks urgent phrasing. The problem persists for a week, students are affected, and the associate learns that reporting honestly achieved nothing.
- A summary states that a fee issue was "resolved" when the report said it was "being resolved". The reviewer signs off, and a student is blocked from class the next day.
- Operational text including a named student's personal circumstances is sent to an external API without a considered basis, and the institution has no answer when asked where that data went.
- A manager begins using severity distributions as an informal ranking of associates. Associates learn to write reports that score well rather than reports that are true.

Controls

Control	Addresses	Status
No autonomy — AI cannot advance any state or send any message	R1, R2, R3	Enforced by the existing state machine
Mandatory source citation for every generated claim, shown in the interface	R1	Designed for the pilot
Rules can raise severity but never lower it	R3	Designed for the pilot
Auto-sign-off disabled for any item marked serious	R2, R3	Configuration change to existing behaviour
Two-sided override band monitored weekly, reasons read by a human	R2	Part of the evaluation harness
Row-level security enforcing campus scoping at the database, not only in application code	R4	Live in production
Data minimisation — identifiers redacted before the API call wherever the task does not need them	R5	Designed; a launch prerequisite
Bias audit on the weekly sample, comparing severity across campuses and authors	R6	Part of the evaluation harness
Written policy that AI outputs are never used in staff performance assessment	R7	Governance commitment, signed off before the pilot
Immutable audit log capturing model output, prompt version and human decision together	R1–R7	Live in production
Documentation, runbook and a second engineer before Phase 2	R9	Open — a gate on expansion

Privacy position

Operational text can incidentally contain personal information. The position is data minimisation before capability: identifiers are stripped from text sent to the model wherever the task does not require them, because severity classification almost never depends on knowing which named student was involved. Where an identifier is genuinely needed, the reference stays inside the platform and the model receives a placeholder. Retention follows the platform's existing policy, and the audit log records what was sent for every call. Alignment with the institution's obligations, including India's Digital Personal Data Protection Act, is treated as a prerequisite for the pilot.

Launch blockers

Any one of these stops the launch. They are absolutes: a blocker that can be negotiated under delivery pressure is not a blocker.

- Any cross-campus or cross-role data exposure, even once, even in a test.
- Ungrounded statements above five per cent of sampled summary statements.
- P1 severity recall below 0.90 on the labelled weekly sample.
- No data-minimisation step in place before text is sent to the model API.
- Absence of a working single-flag rollback to rules-only ordering.
- Any proposal to use the layer for staff performance evaluation.